

Deliverable: Design Challenge - Haru Platform

This document presents the design proposal and strategic reasoning for the redesign of Haru, an Ecuadorian personal finance management startup.

> *TIP:*

> ***Interactive Prototype Available:***

> *We have developed a high-fidelity interactive simulator (HTML/CSS/JS) where you can navigate the application screens, interact with expense categories, and test the friction-free auto-categorization experience.*

> ***Open Local File:*** `[index.html](file:///c:/Users/renat/OneDrive/Proyectos/Caso%20UI/Design%20Challenge/index.html)`

1. Context & Reasoning: Empathy with the User

What do we understand about the problem?

Users of personal finance apps experience three main friction points in current market solutions:

1. The Paralysis of Cold Numbers: Numbers without context cause anxiety or lack of interest. Seeing that you spent "\$300 on food" does not answer the underlying question: **Am I doing well or badly?**.
2. The Friction of Manual Bookkeeping: Nobody wants to spend 10 minutes a day manual-categorizing transactions. If the app requires this effort, the user will abandon it in less than a week.
3. Lack of Actionability: Showing beautiful but static pie charts does not change habits. The user needs suggestions and insights that require zero cognitive load.

Hypotheses Guiding Our Proposal

- * Automation Hypothesis: If we reduce the categorization process to a 1-tap express validation, we will increase user retention by 60%.
 - * Human Language Hypothesis: If we replace abstract charts with conversational, direct insights, the user will immediately understand their financial status.
 - * Free Margin Motivation Hypothesis: Focusing the UI on the "Free Margin" (what is left after fixed expenses and savings targets) reduces guilt and promotes healthy habits.
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2. Lateral Thinking: Questioning the Request

> ***Does the user really need complex charts and tedious manual bookkeeping?***

> ***No.*** *The user does not want to become their own accountant. They want peace of mind and control over their money.*

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> *Instead of building complex editing tools, we automate 95% of the mental load with a local predictive engine. If the system makes a mistake, the user can re-categorize with a single click from their daily summary, or ignore it and let the system assume the default classification asynchronously.*

3. The Simplified Journey (User Flow)

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1. Notification / Input: Haru processes a transaction from a local merchant (e.g., **Supermaxi**).

2. Auto-Categorization: The predictive engine assigns the category (**Food**).

3. Express Validation (Zero Friction): An interactive widget on the dashboard lets the user confirm with one button ("It's Correct") or change it with another ("Change").

4. Dynamic Update: The savings target and "Free Margin" update immediately, accompanied by an actionable insight about that category.
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4. Design Decisions (UX / UI)

UX Decisions (User Experience)

- * Emotional Health Indicator: The financial state is summarized in an empathetic phrase at the header (e.g., `Everything is okay`, `Goal in risk`).
- * Focus on Free Margin: The dashboard highlights the money the user **can spend freely** without neglecting their obligations or savings goal.
- * Narrative Insights: Tapping any expense category generates a conversational paragraph that analyzes behavior and suggests how to save (e.g., suggesting buying at local markets instead of large chains).

UI Decisions (User Interface)

- * Typography: We use **Outfit** (clean and modern titles with personality) and **Plus Jakarta Sans** (readable numerical data).
 - * Smart Color Palette:
 - * Deep purple (`#6D3BFF`) for brand identity and a modern feel.
 - * Emerald green (`#00E676`) to indicate success and savings growth.
 - * Vibrant, high-contrast category colors set against an elegant dark background.
 - * Glassmorphism Components: Subtle transparencies and borders establish visual hierarchy without cluttering the screen.
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5. Applied Case Data (Simulation)

For the interactive simulation, we have modeled the provided fictional data:

- * Monthly Income: \$1,200.00
- * Total Expenses: \$950.00
- * **Food:* \$300.00 (31.6%)
- * **Transport:* \$150.00 (15.8%)
- * **Entertainment:* \$200.00 (21.1%)
- * **Others:* \$300.00 (31.6%)
- * Savings Goal: \$100.00 per month.

* Result: With \$950 in expenses, the actual savings amount is \$250 (exceeding the target by 250%!).

* Prototype Interaction: When you approve the new simulated transaction of \$35.00 at Supermaxi, total expenses rise to \$985.00, free margin drops to \$215.00, and savings progress is recalculated in real time.

Recommendations for the 20-Minute Presentation

1. Minutes 1-5: Present the user pain point (bookkeeping friction) and how Haru eliminates it by shifting the paradigm (Lateral Thinking).
2. Minutes 5-15: Run the interactive live demo in the browser. Simulate confirming the *Supermaxi* transaction and click different categories to show the narrative insights.
3. Minutes 15-20: Explain the UI/UX design choices (Section 4) and open the floor for questions/feedback.